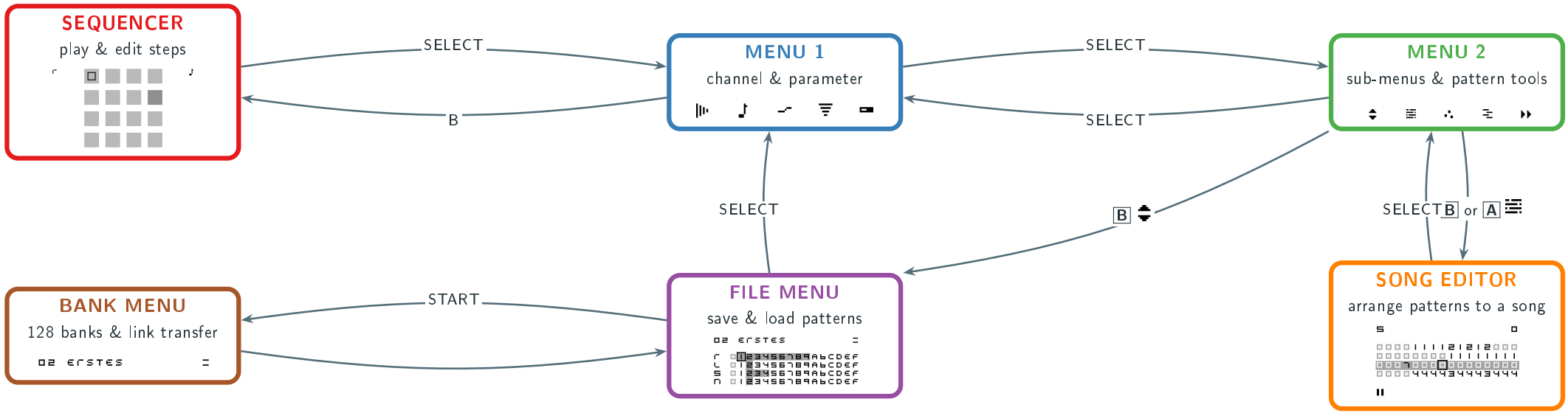
nanoloop 2 · cheatsheet

unofficial summary of the official 2.8 manual · GBA cart & Analogue Pocket built-in version

Notation: B + ▲ = hold B, tap D-pad up. All sound parameters are set *per step* – there are no instruments. Channel is shown top-left, edit parameter top-right.

WORKFLOW – modes & how to move between them



THE SEQUENCER

16 steps in a 4×4 grid; the playing step is darker.

- ▲▼◀▶ ..... move cursor
- B ..... place note
- A ..... cut note / paste on empty step
- B + ▲▼◀▶ ..... edit note (current parameter)
- A + ▲▼◀▶ ..... edit extra parameters
- START ..... mono / chord mode (pitch param)
- R + ◀▶ ..... meta step
- SELECT ..... menu 1

Default parameter is pitch: B + ▲▼ semitone, B + ◀▶ octave.

Meta step: *R + ◀/▶/▼ makes a step play only every 2nd or 4th pattern round.*

CHANNELS

- r ..... mono, arp, pitch env/LFO
- l ..... mono, same as r
- s ..... poly, real chords, stereo
- n ..... noise, filter/speed, arp

r/l/s: filtered pulse wave (variable width) or FM (mod amount + freq). s adds stereo phasing + filter/mod env; n arp is on speed.

SYNC

S8 click every 2nd step (default; PO, Volca...)
S16 1 click per step
S24 3 clicks/step – for MIDI adaptor
SY1 clicks on left audio ch. (PO slave; not on GBA)

- A + ▲▼ ..... set sync mode (in menu 2)
- B + SELECT ..... CV sync (slave mode)
- B ..... start: pattern-sync
- A ..... start: manual / external

CV sync: "c" under the tempo, 1 pulse per step. MIDI clock goes out via the link port (Pocket-to-MIDI cable).

Manual start: *START begins at once and sends sync; B + A = slave.* ***S16 auto-revert:*** *no clock for ~2 s → back to step 1.*

MENU 1 – channel & parameter

◀▶ ..... select parameter
▲▼ ..... select channel
A + START ..... mute / unmute ch.
R + START ..... value / bar view
B ..... back to sequencer
R + ▲▼◀▶ ..... randomise
R + SELECT ..... new / legacy mode
SELECT ..... menu 2

Randomise: repeat presses widen the range. Legacy mode: A + D-pad edits only (pre-2.8 style).

PITCH / CHORD

B + ▲▼ ..... semitone
B + ◀▶ ..... octave
START ..... chord mode on/off
B + START ..... rel. / abs. chord
A + ▲▼ ..... chord interval
A + ◀▶ ..... select chord step
L ..... arpeggio env. on/off

Chords: arpeggio on r/l, polyphonic on s. n has no pitch – always arpeggio (on playback frequency). Chord step: top note = pause.

VOLUME / ENVELOPE

B + ▲▼ ..... volume
B + ◀▶ ..... length
A + ▲▼ ..... envelope: D / AD / gate
A + ◀▶ ..... click (r) / soft (l,s,n)

D = decay only. AD = attack = decay. Gate = full level for the set length. Far right = infinite envelope.

BEND / LFO

B + ▲▼ ..... amplitude
B + ◀▶ ..... length / frequency
A + ▲▼ ..... envelope / LFO
A + ◀▶ ..... s only: pitch / filter

Acts on pitch (r,l,s) and filter cutoff / FM mod depth (s,n). Lower half = retriggered, upper = free-running.

WAVEFORM

B + ▲▼ ..... cutoff / FM modulation
B + ◀▶ ..... pulse width / mod freq
A + ▲ ..... FM (r,l,s) / GB noise (n)
A + ▼ ..... PWM / highpass noise (n)
A + ▶ ..... bandpass / metallic noise
A + ◀ ..... highpass / white noise

On n: B + ◀▶ = noise speed; L toggles GB noise 16/8 bit.

PAN / DELAY

B + ◀▶ ..... panning (s and n only)
B + ▲▼ ..... delay / delay + orig.

Editing delay for all notes from menu 1 hits only even steps – that is the swing control.

MENU 2 – sub-menus & pattern tools

B (or A) opens the selected sub-menu / function below
SELECT ..... back to menu 1
A + ▲▼ ..... sync mode (page 1)

FILE MENU

128 banks × 15 slots per channel. Slot 0 is read-only (loads an empty pattern). The bank also carries the waveforms – switching banks can change the sound at once.

▲▼ select channel · ◀▶ select slot · START bank menu · SELECT back to menu 1

B + ▼ ..... save pattern to slot
B + R + ▲ ..... load pattern + tempo
A + ◀▶ ..... next column + load all
A + B + ▲ ..... load column @ step 1
A + B + ◀▶ ..... mute/unmute/solo
A + ▼ ..... save all 4 (column)
B + ▲ ..... load pattern
A + ▲ ..... load column
B + ◀▶ ..... next slot + load
A + B + ▼ ..... delete slot

Lock: L + R locks saving ("X" shown), against accidental overwriting.
Bank menu: A + B + ▲ copy bank · A + B + ▼ paste bank · B + ▲▼ edit bank name
Transfer: A + B + ▲ send bank · A + B + ▼ receive bank · on error: SELECT cancels, A + B keeps the data.

SONG EDITOR

B + ▲▼ ..... select pattern
B + ◀▶ ..... copy value to next
A + ▲ ..... load patterns @ cursor
A + ◀▶ ..... turn page (15 pages)
R ..... channel follows tempo
L ..... channel follows length
START ..... start song at cursor
SELECT ..... back to menu 2

Saved on leaving the editor, not on power-off. Tempo is stored per pattern.

PING-PONG

B + ◀ ..... on
START ..... random
B + ▶ ..... normal (off)

SHIFT

B + ▲▼ ..... length
B + ◀▶ ..... shift
A + ◀▶ ..... shift+delay
START ..... copy pattern
A + B ..... paste

TEMPO

B + ◀▶ ..... tempo
B + ▲▼ ..... 1/x tempo
START ..... start / master
A + B ..... stop / slave
A ..... pause / step
B ..... resume